

TEMPLATE P30 · SCALE OR RETIRE DECISION

# Scale or retire decision

Substantiates the G7 decision —scale, iterate or retire— with evidence, plans the retirement where appropriate and captures the lessons learned.

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## 01

# Instructions for use

| Aspect                 | Guidance                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it is used        | Phase 7 (Evolution or retirement), before G7. Also when an R6 continuity review brings G7 forward due to relevant deviations, and in the regularisation of systems pre-dating the adoption of the framework (01 §14). |
| Who completes it       | AI Product Owner (evidence, options and lessons), with the AI Operations Owner (retirement plan).                                                                                                                     |
| Who verifies it        | AI Office at Lite intensity; AI Auditor at Enterprise intensity.                                                                                                                                                      |
| Who decides            | Sponsor at Lite intensity; AI Committee at Enterprise intensity. Scaling a Transform initiative also requires board approval (01 §7.5). The decision is recorded in P29.                                              |
| Lite versus Enterprise | Lite may omit the fields marked <b>(Enterprise)</b> . The retirement plan (block 8) is always completed when the outcome is Retire.                                                                                   |

| Aspect       | Guidance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tool         | T22 Retirement manager.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Relationship | P07 Ambition classification (review in phase 7) · P12 Risk register · P16 Lineage · P20 Adoption and capacity · P27 Incident and change log · P28 Value tracking · P29 <i>Gate</i> decision record · document 14 (Portfolio management). |

Rules:

- **Evolve or retire:** no initiative remains in the portfolio without evidence to justify it (01 §3, principle 6).
- Every retirement records the **date, reason, deciding body, replacement if any, treatment of data and models, and communication to those affected** (01 §6.9).
- The initiative only moves to *Retired* status in the register when the retirement plan has been **executed and verified** (03 §3.2).
- A well-founded decision to retire is a valid outcome of the method.

This template does not constitute legal advice. The retention and deletion of data must be validated with data protection and legal counsel.

## 02

# Identification

| Field                    | Content                                                                       | Guidance |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Initiative code          | IA-AAAA-NNN (T01).                                                            |          |
| Initiative name          |                                                                               |          |
| AI system(s)             | Identifier in the inventory (T02).                                            |          |
| Confirmed ambition level | Optimise · Augment · Transform.                                               |          |
| Intensity                | Lite · Enterprise.                                                            |          |
| Origin of the decision   | Ordinary G7 · G7 brought forward by R6 · Regularisation · Portfolio decision. |          |
| Go-live date             |                                                                               |          |
| Document version         |                                                                               |          |

| Field           | Content | Guidance                                                               |
|-----------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Author          |         | Role and name.                                                         |
| Date            |         | DD-MM-YYYY.                                                            |
| Document status |         | Draft · Submitted for verification · Verified · Approved · Superseded. |

### 03

## Summary of the evidence

| Magnitude                                                  | Value | Status or source                 | Guidance                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Realised annual efficiencies (€)                           |       | Validated · Declared · Estimated | P28.                                    |
| Realised annual return (€)                                 |       |                                  | P28.                                    |
| Actual annual recurring cost (€)                           |       |                                  | P28.                                    |
| Annual net value (€)                                       |       |                                  | Efficiencies + return – recurring cost. |
| Proportion of validated value                              |       |                                  | P28.                                    |
| Expected annual net value in the hypothesis (€)            |       |                                  | P08.                                    |
| Released capacity: realised · reassigned · pending (hours) |       |                                  | P28 block 6; not counted.               |
| Total investment made (€)                                  |       |                                  |                                         |
| Main residual risk and trend                               |       | Low · Medium · High · Critical   | P12.                                    |
| S1–S2 incidents since go-live                              |       |                                  | P27.                                    |
| Open nonconformities                                       |       |                                  | Document 37.                            |
| Adoption against target                                    |       |                                  | P20.                                    |
| Currency of the regulatory classification                  |       | Current · Requires review        | P11.                                    |

# Declared versus actual ambition

The five classification questions are answered again using actual evidence (00 \$5.2).

| # | Question                                                                                         | Answer in phase 2 (Yes · No) | Answer with actual evidence (Yes · No) | Evidence |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------|
| 1 | Does it change the value proposition received by the customer or end user?                       |                              |                                        |          |
| 2 | Is the process redesigned end to end, and not just a task?                                       |                              |                                        |          |
| 3 | Do roles, organisational structure or who makes which decisions change?                          |                              |                                        |          |
| 4 | Does it generate revenue, services or markets that did not exist before?                         |                              |                                        |          |
| 5 | Could it be retired without affecting the business model, simply returning to the previous cost? |                              |                                        |          |

| Field                                                     | Content | Guidance                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Actual ambition level                                     |         | Optimise · Augment · Transform. If it differs from the confirmed level, P07 and the register are updated.                                                              |
| Compliance with the G7 criterion for the level (01 \$7.6) |         | Optimise: realised savings · Augment: sustained performance and reassigned capacity · Transform: measured return and verified change. Status: Met · Not met · Pending. |

# Options assessed

| Option  | Arguments for | Arguments against | Additional investment (€) | Expected additional annual net value (€) | Additional net value per euro | Timeframe |
|---------|---------------|-------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------|
| Scale   |               |                   |                           |                                          |                               |           |
| Iterate |               |                   |                           |                                          | —                             |           |

| Option | Arguments for | Arguments against | Additional investment (€) | Expected additional annual net value (€) | Additional net value per euro | Timeframe |
|--------|---------------|-------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------|
| Retire |               |                   | Retirement cost           | Recurring cost savings minus value lost  | —                             |           |

A scaling potential without additional investment, hypothesis and timeframe is not a data point (measurement rule 4).

## 06

# Decision

| Field                    | Content | Guidance                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Outcome                  |         | Scale · Iterate · Retire.                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Reason                   |         | Based on blocks 3 to 5.                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Coded reason (if Retire) |         | No plausible value · Hypothesis refuted · Insufficient data · Technically unfeasible · Cost exceeds value · Unacceptable risk · Regulation · No adoption · Replaced by another solution · Change in strategic priority. |
| Deciding body and date   |         | Sponsor (Lite) · AI Committee (Enterprise).                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Board approval           |         | Mandatory for Scale in Transform. Date and reference of the minutes.                                                                                                                                                    |
| Gate decision record     |         | Reference to P29.                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

## 07

# If scaling or iterating

| Field                  | Content | Guidance                                             |
|------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Extended scope (Scale) |         | New areas, countries, users, use cases or functions. |

| Field                                                         | Content | Guidance                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>New phase 0 (Scale)</b>                                    |         | The extended scope starts a new phase 0 with its charter (P01); its treatment in the register is governed by document 14. |
| <b>Planned changes in intensity or classification (Scale)</b> |         | For example, the extended scope introduces direct exposure to customers.                                                  |
| <b>Phase to return to (Iterate)</b>                           |         | And what must change in order to return to G7.                                                                            |
| <b>Planned date of the new review (Iterate)</b>               |         |                                                                                                                           |

## 08

# Retirement plan

## 8.1 General information

| Field                                                    | Content | Guidance                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Date of the decision</b>                              |         |                                                                                            |
| <b>Effective retirement date</b>                         |         | Date on which the system ceases to produce effects.                                        |
| <b>Coded reason</b>                                      |         | The one in block 6.                                                                        |
| <b>Deciding body</b>                                     |         |                                                                                            |
| <b>Replacement</b>                                       |         | Another AI system · Non-AI solution · Manual process · None. Identifier if it is a system. |
| <b>Transition to the replacement</b>                     |         | Coexistence period, cut-over criteria and capacity required.                               |
| <b>Estimated cost of the retirement (€) (Enterprise)</b> |         |                                                                                            |

## 8.2 Treatment of data and models

| Item                                           | Treatment (Retain · Anonymise · Delete · Return · Archive) | Basis (legal obligation, audit, legal defence, end of purpose) | Time limit | Owner | Evidence (for example, deletion certificate, P57 §8) |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Training data and datasets (P16)               |                                                            |                                                                |            |       |                                                      |
| Knowledge base                                 |                                                            |                                                                |            |       |                                                      |
| Inference and action logs                      |                                                            |                                                                |            |       |                                                      |
| Data held by suppliers                         |                                                            |                                                                |            |       |                                                      |
| Models and versions                            |                                                            |                                                                |            |       |                                                      |
| System instructions and configuration          |                                                            |                                                                |            |       |                                                      |
| Technical documentation and lifecycle evidence | Archive                                                    | Audit and traceability                                         |            |       |                                                      |

## 8.3 Technical and contractual decommissioning

| Action                                                                     | Owner | Date | Status (Pending · Done · Verified) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|------------------------------------|
| Deactivate the system and its integrations                                 |       |      |                                    |
| Revoke agent identities, credentials and permissions (P18)                 |       |      |                                    |
| Cancel licences and access to third-party models                           |       |      |                                    |
| Terminate or adapt contracts; request deletion or return from the supplier |       |      |                                    |
| Remove alerts and dashboards, retaining the history                        |       |      |                                    |
| Update the AI system inventory (T02)                                       |       |      |                                    |
| Update regulatory registrations where appropriate (Enterprise)             |       |      |                                    |

## 8.4 Communication to those affected

| Recipient                                                | Message | Channel | Date | Owner |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------|------|-------|
| Internal users                                           |         |         |      |       |
| Customers or affected individuals                        |         |         |      |       |
| Employee representatives, where appropriate (Enterprise) |         |         |      |       |
| Suppliers                                                |         |         |      |       |
| Authorities, where appropriate                           |         |         |      |       |

## 8.5 People and capacity

| Field                                     | Content | Guidance                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| People who operated or oversaw the system |         | New assignment.                                                                       |
| Capacity needed again                     |         | If the released capacity had been reassigned or realised, how the process is covered. |

## 8.6 Verification of the retirement

| Field                  | Content | Guidance                                                   |
|------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Verification date      |         |                                                            |
| Verified by            |         | AI Office (Lite) · AI Auditor (Enterprise).                |
| Result                 |         | Executed · Executed with pending items · Not executed.     |
| Status in the register |         | Only with <i>Executed</i> does it move to <i>Retired</i> . |

# Lessons learned

**Applicable to:** This initiative · Portfolio · Company governance framework.

| #                               | What happened                         | Why it happened                                           | What will be done differently                               | Applicable to | Owner for incorporating it | Taken to C5? (Yes · No) |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1 <i>(illustrative example)</i> | Adoption stalled at 40% of the target | The tool added a step to the process without removing any | Redesign the process before building in Augment initiatives | Portfolio     | AI Office                  | Yes                     |
|                                 |                                       |                                                           |                                                             |               |                            |                         |
|                                 |                                       |                                                           |                                                             |               |                            |                         |
|                                 |                                       |                                                           |                                                             |               |                            |                         |

# Quality criteria

Formal G7 criteria in document 21; LV-G7 checklist in document 22.

| # | Check                                                                                            | Status (Met · Not met · Not applicable · Pending) |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The value evidence comes from P28, with statuses and validated proportion.                       |                                                   |
| 2 | The actual ambition has been reviewed using the five questions.                                  |                                                   |
| 3 | The options have investment, additional net value and timeframe where applicable.                |                                                   |
| 4 | The outcome is Scale, Iterate or Retire, with a reason, and with a coded reason if it is Retire. |                                                   |
| 5 | Scaling in Transform has board approval.                                                         |                                                   |
| 6 | The retirement plan covers date, reason, body, replacement, data and models, and communication.  |                                                   |
| 7 | The retirement is verified before the initiative is marked as <i>Retired</i> .                   |                                                   |

| # | Check                                    | Status (Met · Not met · Not applicable · Pending) |
|---|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 8 | There are lessons learned with an owner. |                                                   |

11

Approval and verification

| Function        | Role                                                                    | Name | Date | Signature or reference |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|------|------------------------|
| Author          | AI Product Owner                                                        |      |      |                        |
| Retirement plan | AI Operations Owner                                                     |      |      |                        |
| Data review     | Data protection                                                         |      |      |                        |
| Verifier        | AI Office (Lite) · AI Auditor (Enterprise)                              |      |      |                        |
| Decision-maker  | Sponsor (Lite) · AI Committee (Enterprise) · Board (Scale in Transform) |      |      |                        |

Segregation of duties: the verifier and the decision-maker are not part of the team that builds or operates the system.

12

Version control

| Version | Date       | Changes                        |
|---------|------------|--------------------------------|
| 0.1     | 16-09-2026 | First version of the template. |